26900236 **Reg.No : .....**

Name : .....

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (Honours)/ MGU-BBA (Honours)/ MGU-BCA (Honours)

Regular EXAMINATION October 2026

Fifth SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Elective (DSE) - MG5DSEFSQA00 - RAILWAY FOOD SERVICE SYSTEM

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

Students should attempt at least one question from each course outcome to enhance their overall outcome attainability.

Part A

MCQ

Answer all questions

Each question carries **1** marks

1. Select the management function that involves assigning duties to catering staff. [U] / [CO1]

   a). Advertising

   b). Auditing

   c). Recruitment

   d). Organizing

2. Recognize the budget that estimates the income and expenditure of a railway catering unit. [U] / [CO1]

   a). Operating budget

   b). Maintenance schedule

c). Train timetable

d). Reservation chart

3. Classify fresh vegetables, meat and milk under the appropriate purchasing category. [U] / [CO1]

a). Non-food materials

b). Perishable food items

c). Cleaning equipment

d). Stationery items

4. Recognize the operational practice that reduces unnecessary expenditure in railway catering units. [U] / [CO1]

a). Monitoring food waste regularly

b). Increasing menu duplication

c). Preparing food without demand estimates

d). Keeping excess cooked food daily

5. Identify the principal beneficiary of railway food service operations. [U] / [CO1]

a). Railway passengers

b). Railway contractors

c). Coach manufacturers

d). Railway engineers

6. Associate regular inspection of catering units with its purpose under IRCTC guidelines. [U] / [CO2]

a). Increasing passenger fares

b). Improving locomotive performance

c). Ensuring compliance with hygiene and quality standards

d). Managing train schedules

7. Recognize the equipment used for mechanical mixing of ingredients during large-scale food preparation. [U] / [CO2]

   a). Steam boiler

   b). Hot cupboard

   c). Planetary mixer

   d). Refrigerator

8. Distinguish the storage practice that prevents cross-contamination in railway catering units. [U] / [CO2]

   a). Separating raw and cooked foods

   b). Storing all foods together

   c). Keeping food uncovered

   d). Using damaged containers

9. Recognize the preparation technique that combines dry and moist heat for cooking meat dishes. [U] / [CO2]

   a). Braising

   b). Grilling

   c). Roasting

   d). Steaming

10. Associate seasonal menu planning with its primary advantage in railway catering. [U] / [CO2]

    a). Increasing food wastage

    b). Reducing food safety

    c). Delaying meal service

    d). Reducing cost while maintaining food quality

11. Recognize the factor that should be considered while planning menus for long-distance train journeys. [U] / [CO2]

a). Colour of railway coaches

b). Number of ticket counters

c). Shelf life and ease of service

d). Train engine model

12. Distinguish the hygiene practice that best supports safe food handling in railway food service units. [U] / [CO3]

a). Maintaining personal, equipment and environmental hygiene

b). Using damaged utensils

c). Leaving food uncovered during service

d). Allowing waste to accumulate near the kitchen

13. Distinguish the quality control measure that best ensures compliance with railway catering standards. [U] / [CO3]

a). Preparing food without standard procedures

b). Using ingredients without quality verification

c). Ignoring customer feedback

d). Regular monitoring, inspection and corrective actions

14. Recognize the purpose of isolating suspected contaminated food during a foodborne illness incident. [U] / [CO3]

a). Improving food appearance

b). Reducing cooking time

c). Preventing further consumption and contamination

d). Increasing food production

15. Distinguish the cleaning procedure that best complies with hygiene standards for food contact equipment. [U] / [CO3]

a). Clean only with water

b). Wash, rinse, sanitize and air dry before use

c). Wash once at the end of the week

d). Use the equipment without sanitizing

16. Identify the common symptom of foodborne illness among passengers. [U] / [CO3]

a). Hearing loss

b). Vision impairment

c). Diarrhoea

d). Hair loss

17. Associate sanitization of cutting boards with its primary purpose. [U] / [CO3]

a). Improving cutting speed

b). Preventing cross-contamination between food items

c). Reducing equipment weight

d). Increasing shelf space

18. Select the behaviour that demonstrates professionalism while serving passengers in railway catering. [U] / [CO4]

a). Ignoring passenger requests

b). Arguing with passengers

c). Treating all passengers with courtesy and respect

d). Serving food carelessly

19. Distinguish the customer service technique that supports effective complaint handling. [U] / [CO4]

a). Ignoring complaints

b). Blaming passengers

c). Listening carefully and offering appropriate solutions

d). Refusing assistance

20. Distinguish the practice that leads to effective resolution of service issues. [U] / [CO4]

a). Avoiding responsibility

b). Arguing with passengers

c). Providing inaccurate information

d). Responding politely and taking corrective action

[1x20 = 20]

Part B

Short Answer

Answer any **6** questions

Each question carries **5** marks

21. Explain the methods used for maintaining inventory records in railway food service operations. [U] / [CO1]

22. Describe the different food preservation methods used in railway catering. [U] / [CO2]

23. Summarize the factors affecting food safety standards in railway food service units. [U] / [CO3]

24. Summarize the strategies used to improve railway food service based on passenger feedback and preferences. [U] / [CO4]

25. Describe the different types of food service operations available in railways. [U] / [CO1]

26. Discuss the importance of cleaning and sanitation of food production equipment. [U] / [CO2]

27. Explain the major functions performed by IRCTC in railway catering and hospitality services. [U] / [CO2]

28. Summarize the factors influencing effective service standards in railway food service operations. [U] / [CO4]

[5x6 = 30]

Part C

Essays

Answer any **2** questions

Each question carries **10** marks

29. Explain in detail the procedures for handling customer complaints in railway catering services, including identification, response, resolution, and follow-up. [U] / [CO4]

30. Explain in detail the procedures involved in monitoring and maintaining food safety standards in railway food service operations. [U] / [CO3]

31. Explain in detail the organizational structure of railway food service units and the role of different levels of management in effective operation. [U] / [CO1]

32. Explain in detail the different cooking methods used in railway catering, including moist heat, dry heat, and combination cooking methods. [U] / [CO2]

[10x2 = 20]